THE BRITISH CONQUEST OF BENGAL (PLASSEY 1757, BUXAR 1764, DUAL GOVERNMENT)

BENGAL BEFORE 1756: SUCCESSOR → CALCUTTA CRISIS AND THE → PLASSEY'S HIDDEN BATTLE: CONSPIRACY → PLASSEY AND THE MIR → MIR QASIM: REFORM, EQUALITY → BUXAR: COALITION BREADTH VERSUS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

BENGAL BEFORE 1756: SUCCESSOR STATE AND SOVEREIGNTY CONFLICT

BENGAL BEFORE 1756 · SUCCESSOR STATE AND SOVEREIGNTY CONFLICT · WEALTHY MUGHAL SUCCESSOR STATE, NOT A POLITICAL VACUUM · 1717 FARMAN · BOUNDED PRIVILEGE FOR COMPANY TRADE · DASTAK ABUSE · SERVANTS' PRIVATE TRADE · FORTIFICATION + CUSTOMS + JURISDICTION

BENGAL → wealthy Mughal successor state, not a political vacuum

1717 FARMAN → bounded privilege for Company trade → DASTAK ABUSE → servants' private trade → FORTIFICATION + customs + jurisdiction → commercial dispute becomes sovereignty dispute

CORE CLAIM
- BENGAL → wealthy Mughal successor state, not a political vacuum
- 1717 FARMAN → bounded privilege for Company trade
- DASTAK ABUSE → servants' private trade

MECHANISM
- FORTIFICATION + customs + jurisdiction → commercial dispute becomes sovereignty dispute
- SIRAJ 1756 → inherits court rivalry and a Company testing Nawabi authority.
- MUST REMEMBER: Plassey on 23 June 1757, Buxar on 22 October 1764, the 1765

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- Allahabad settlement and Diwani grant, and the 1765-72 Dual Government are separate stages.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Plassey on 23 June 1757, Buxar on 22 October 1764, the 1765 Allahabad settlement and Diwani grant, and the 1765-72 Dual Government are separate stages.

01

STAGE 01

CALCUTTA CRISIS AND THE BLACK HOLE CAUTION

CALCUTTA CRISIS AND THE BLACK HOLE CAUTION · UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION · KASIMBAZAR SEIZED · FORT WILLIAM FALLS IN JUNE 1756 · CALCUTTA RECOVERED · CHANDERNAGORE REMOVED AS COUNTERWEIGHT · BLACK HOLE · HOLWELL IS AN INTERESTED, WEAKLY CORROBORATED NARRATOR

UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION → Kasimbazar seized → Fort William falls in June 1756

CLIVE / WATSON → Calcutta recovered → Alinagar → Chandernagore removed as counterweight → BLACK HOLE → Holwell is an interested, weakly corroborated narrator → RULE → never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of

CORE CLAIM
- UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION → Kasimbazar seized → Fort William falls in June 1756
- CLIVE / WATSON → Calcutta recovered → Alinagar → Chandernagore removed as counterweight

MECHANISM
- BLACK HOLE → Holwell is an interested, weakly corroborated narrator
- RULE → never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of conquest.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- UNAUTHORISED FORTIFICATION → Kasimbazar seized → Fort William falls in June 1756
- CLIVE / WATSON → Calcutta recovered → Alinagar → Chandernagore removed as counterweight

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never make a disputed body count or atrocity story the causal centre of conquest.

02

STAGE 02

PLASSEY'S HIDDEN BATTLE: CONSPIRACY AND COLLABORATION

PLASSEY'S HIDDEN BATTLE · CONSPIRACY AND COLLABORATION · REGIME-CHANGE PLAN + SECRET CORRESPONDENCE + COERCIVE LEVERAGE · MIR JAFAR · JAGAT SETH · CREDIT AND SECURITY · RAI DURLABH · BROKER LATER DECEIVED

COMPANY / CLIVE → regime-change plan + secret correspondence + coercive leverage

MIR JAFAR → throne → JAGAT SETH → credit and security → RAI DURLABH → office

CORE CLAIM
- COMPANY / CLIVE → regime-change plan + secret correspondence + coercive leverage
- MIR JAFAR → throne
- JAGAT SETH → credit and security

MECHANISM
- RAI DURLABH → office
- AMICHAND → broker later deceived
- MIR MADAN / MOHAN LAL → loyal resistance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- VERDICT → interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → interests explain collaboration better than a one-word betrayal morality tale.

03

STAGE 03

PLASSEY AND THE MIR JAFAR CLIENT REGIME

PLASSEY AND THE MIR JAFAR CLIENT REGIME · PLASSEY, 23 JUNE 1757 · CONSPIRACY NEUTRALISES MOST NAWABI COMMAND · MIR JAFAR INSTALLED; COMPANY BECOMES KINGMAKER AND GAINS POLITICAL · CLIENT CYCLE · DEEPER COMPANY LEVERAGE · PLASSEY CHANGED THE RULER; IT DID NOT YET GRANT

CORE CLAIM
- PLASSEY, 23 JUNE 1757 → conspiracy neutralises most Nawabi command
- RESULT → Mir Jafar installed; Company becomes kingmaker and gains political entry

MECHANISM
- CLIENT CYCLE → dependence → transfers / concessions → deeper Company leverage
- LIMIT → Plassey changed the ruler; it did not yet grant legal-fiscal sovereignty.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PLASSEY, 23 JUNE 1757 → conspiracy neutralises most Nawabi command
- RESULT → Mir Jafar installed; Company becomes kingmaker and gains political entry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → Mir Jafar installed; Company becomes kingmaker and gains political entry.

04

STAGE 04

MIR QASIM: REFORM, EQUALITY AND CONFLICT

MIR QASIM · REFORM, EQUALITY AND CONFLICT · MIR QASIM 1760 · SHIFTS CAPITAL TO MUNGER + STRENGTHENS ADMINISTRATION AND ARMY · COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE · DUTY PRIVILEGE DISTORTS COMPETITION AND WEAKENS NAWABI REVENUE · RESPONSE 1763 · ABOLISH INLAND DUTIES FOR ALL TRADERS

MIR QASIM 1760 → shifts capital to Munger + strengthens administration and army → COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE → duty privilege distorts competition and weakens Nawabi revenue → RESPONSE 1763 → abolish inland duties for all traders: equality, not modern nationalism → COMPANY RESISTS LOST ADVANTAGE → war → Mir Qasim seeks an Awadh-Mughal coalition.

CORE CLAIM
- MIR QASIM 1760 → shifts capital to Munger + strengthens administration and army
- COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE → duty privilege distorts competition and weakens Nawabi revenue

MECHANISM
- RESPONSE 1763 → abolish inland duties for all traders: equality, not modern nationalism
- COMPANY RESISTS LOST ADVANTAGE → war → Mir Qasim seeks an Awadh-Mughal coalition.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MIR QASIM 1760 → shifts capital to Munger + strengthens administration and army
- COMPANY PRIVATE TRADE → duty privilege distorts competition and weakens Nawabi revenue

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPANY RESISTS LOST ADVANTAGE → war → Mir Qasim seeks an Awadh-Mughal coalition.

05

STAGE 05

BUXAR: COALITION BREADTH VERSUS UNIFIED COMPANY COMMAND

COALITION BREADTH VERSUS UNIFIED COMPANY COMMAND · MIR QASIM + SHUJA-UD-DAULA + SHAH ALAM II; DISTINCT · STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS · SEPARATE TREASURIES, COMMANDS AND POLITICAL OBJECTIVES · HECTOR MUNRO'S INTEGRATED COMMAND, SUPPLY AND PAYMENT SYSTEM · BUXAR, 22 OCTOBER 1764 · OPEN MILITARY SUPREMACY, UNLIKE PLASSEY'S PALACE COUP.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
COALITION → Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives	COMPANY → Hector Munro's integrated command, supply and payment system	COALITION → Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives
STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS → separate treasuries, commands and political objectives	BUXAR, 22 OCTOBER 1764 → open military supremacy; unlike Plassey's palace coup.	STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS → separate treasuries, commands and political objectives

CORE CLAIM
- COALITION → Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives
- STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS → separate treasuries, commands and political objectives

MECHANISM
- COMPANY → Hector Munro's integrated command, supply and payment system
- BUXAR, 22 OCTOBER 1764 → open military supremacy, unlike Plassey's palace coup.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- COALITION → Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daula + Shah Alam II; distinct motives
- STRUCTURAL WEAKNESS → separate treasuries, commands and political objectives

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BUXAR, 22 OCTOBER 1764 → open military supremacy, unlike Plassey's palace coup.

06

STAGE 06

THREE-STAGE CONQUEST THESIS

THREE-STAGE CONQUEST THESIS · PLASSEY 1757 · POLITICAL ENTRY · CLIENT NAWAB AND COMPANY KINGMAKING · BUXAR 1764 · MILITARY SUPREMACY · BENGAL-AWADH-EMPEROR COALITION DEFEATED · DIWANI 1765

PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking

BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated → ALLAHABAD / DIWANI 1765 → LEGAL-FISCAL TITLE: revenue authority institutionalised → RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

CORE CLAIM
- PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking
- BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

MECHANISM
- ALLAHABAD / DIWANI 1765 → LEGAL-FISCAL TITLE: revenue authority institutionalised
- RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PLASSEY 1757 → POLITICAL ENTRY: client Nawab and Company kingmaking
- BUXAR 1764 → MILITARY SUPREMACY: Bengal-Awadh-emperor coalition defeated

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → Plassey alone did not complete Company sovereignty over Bengal.

07

STAGE 07

ALLAHABAD, DIWANI, NIZAMAT AND THE AWADH BUFFER

ALLAHABAD, DIWANI, NIZAMAT AND THE AWADH BUFFER · SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT · COMPANY RECEIVES DIWANI OF BENGAL, BIHAR AND ORISSA · SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT · AWADH RESTORED AS A STRATEGIC BUFFER, NOT ANNEXED · CIVIL SIDE · NOMINAL POLICE, CRIMINAL AND MILITARY SIDE · DIWANI WAS NOT NAWABSHIP AND THE LEGAL SPLIT WAS

SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT → Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa

SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT → Awadh restored as a strategic buffer, not annexed → DIWANI → revenue / civil side → NIZAMAT → nominal police, criminal and military side

CORE CLAIM
- SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT → Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa
- SHUJA-UD-DAULA SETTLEMENT → Awadh restored as a strategic buffer, not annexed

MECHANISM
- DIWANI → revenue / civil side
- NIZAMAT → nominal police, criminal and military side

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CAUTION → Diwani was not Nawabship and the legal split was not equal power-sharing.
- SHAH ALAM II SETTLEMENT → Company receives Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → Diwani was not Nawabship and the legal split was not equal power-sharing.

08

STAGE 08

DUAL GOVERNMENT: POWER SEPARATED FROM RESPONSIBILITY

DUAL GOVERNMENT · POWER SEPARATED FROM RESPONSIBILITY · COMPANY HOLDS REVENUE POWER THROUGH INDIAN DEPUTIES · NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT · NOMINAL NIZAMAT AND PUBLIC RESPONSIBILITY WITHOUT RESOURCES · COMPANY POWER WITHOUT RESPONSIBILITY · NAWAB RESPONSIBILITY WITHOUT POWER · EXTRACTION INCENTIVES + DIFFUSED ACCOUNTABILITY + WEAK CORRECTIVE CAPACITY.

CORE CLAIM
- 1765-72 → Company holds revenue power through Indian deputies
- NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT → nominal Nizamat and public responsibility without resources

MECHANISM
- PARADOX → Company power without responsibility / Nawab responsibility without power
- RESULT → extraction incentives + diffused accountability + weak corrective capacity.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- 1765-72 → Company holds revenue power through Indian deputies
- NAWAB'S ESTABLISHMENT → nominal Nizamat and public responsibility without resources

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → extraction incentives + diffused accountability + weak corrective capacity.

09

STAGE 09

FAMINE, ACCOUNTABILITY AND THE 1772 TERMINATION

FAMINE, ACCOUNTABILITY AND THE 1772 TERMINATION · 1770 FAMINE · HARVEST FAILURE · DROUGHT AND DISEASE CREATE THE NATURAL SHOCK · DUAL GOVERNMENT · REVENUE RIGIDITY AND ADMINISTRATIVE CONFUSION AMPLIFY VULNERABILITY · COMPANY POLICY MATTERED BUT DID NOT ALONE CAUSE DROUGHT · HASTINGS 1772

1770 FAMINE → harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock → DUAL GOVERNMENT → revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability → CAUTION → Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe → HASTINGS 1772 → ends Dual Government; direct administration bridges to Topic 06. → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance

CORE CLAIM
- 1770 FAMINE → harvest failure / drought and disease create the natural shock
- DUAL GOVERNMENT → revenue rigidity and administrative confusion amplify vulnerability
- CAUTION → Company policy mattered but did not alone cause drought or the catastrophe

MECHANISM
- HASTINGS 1772 → ends Dual Government; direct administration bridges to Topic 06.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance
- Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- Alam II.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Plassey enabled political leverage through conspiracy and finance; Buxar established a broader military-fiscal superiority against Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daula and Shah.

10

STAGE 10

COMPANY-STATE, EARLY DRAIN MECHANISM AND HISTORIOGRAPHY

COMPANY-STATE, EARLY DRAIN MECHANISM AND HISTORIOGRAPHY · TRADE PRIVILEGE · REVENUE FUNDS PURCHASES AND ARMIES · INDIAN AGENCY · COLLABORATION, RESISTANCE AND ADMINISTRATION OPERATE UNDER UNEQUAL POWER · NATIONALIST EXTRACTION · CORPORATE-FISCAL STATE · BENGAL CONTINUITY

TRADE PRIVILEGE → kingmaking → Diwani → revenue funds purchases and armies

INDIAN AGENCY → collaboration, resistance and administration operate under unequal power → LENSES → nationalist extraction → corporate-fiscal state

CORE CLAIM
- TRADE PRIVILEGE → kingmaking → Diwani → revenue funds purchases and armies
- INDIAN AGENCY → collaboration, resistance and administration operate under unequal power
- LENSES → nationalist extraction

MECHANISM
- corporate-fiscal state
- Bengal continuity
- 2026 MEMORY ANCHOR → revisit Plassey beyond betrayal; static causation remains book-grounded.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Company records and later nationalist accounts must be checked against Bengal court, banking and revenue evidence
- conquest was contingent, collaborative and coercive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Company records and later nationalist accounts must be checked against Bengal court, banking and revenue evidence; conquest was contingent, collaborative and coercive.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 04 ANSWER SPINE AND BOUNDARIES

TOPIC 04 ANSWER SPINE AND BOUNDARIES · SOVEREIGNTY CONFLICT OVER PRIVILEGE, PRIVATE TRADE, FORTIFICATION AND JURISDICTION · CLIENT REGIME · REFORM AND WAR · DUAL GOVERNMENT · COLLABORATION + COMPANY CAPACITY; FAMINE IS MULTICAUSAL; REJECT FALSE · 1772 ENDS THIS TOPIC; EXPANSION AND 1773+ REGULATION PASS

OPEN → sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction → TRACE → conspiracy / client regime → reform and war → Buxar → Diwani → WEIGH → collaboration + Company capacity; famine is multicausal; reject false precision → CLOSE → 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction
- TRACE → conspiracy / client regime → reform and war → Buxar → Diwani → Dual Government

MECHANISM
- WEIGH → collaboration + Company capacity; famine is multicausal; reject false precision
- CLOSE → 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OPEN → sovereignty conflict over privilege, private trade, fortification and jurisdiction
- TRACE → conspiracy / client regime → reform and war → Buxar → Diwani → Dual Government

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → 1772 ends this topic; expansion and 1773+ regulation pass to Topics 05-06.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE COMPANY USED THE 1717 FARMAN AND DASTAKS TO · BEYOND LEGITIMATE COMPANY GOODS, DAMAGING THE NAWAB'S REVENUE AND · COMPANY SERVANTS PURSUED PRIVATE TRADE UNDER THE COVER OF · CREATING A CONFLICT BETWEEN BENGAL'S FISCAL SOVEREIGNTY AND COMPANY · FORTIFICATION OF CALCUTTA WITHOUT NAWAB PERMISSION CHALLENGED SIRAJ-UD-DAULA'S AUTHORITY · THE BLACK HOLE NARRATIVE SHOULD BE TREATED CAUTIOUSLY BECAUSE · PLASSEY WAS A PALACE-AND-BANKING CONSPIRACY INVOLVING MIR JAFAR, RAI

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- The Company used the 1717 farman and dastaks to expand duty-free trade
- beyond legitimate Company goods, damaging the Nawab's revenue and Indian merchants.
- Company servants pursued private trade under the cover of Company privileges,
- creating a conflict between Bengal's fiscal sovereignty and Company commercial immunity.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- Fortification of Calcutta without Nawab permission challenged Siraj-ud-Daula's authority and made the Company appear like a political power.
- CAUTION: The Black Hole narrative should be treated cautiously because its details and later use as imperial justification are contested.
- Plassey was a palace-and-banking conspiracy involving Mir Jafar, Rai Durlabh, Jagat Seth and Amichand
- It gave the Company a pliant Nawab and enormous leverage.

LEGACY / NUANCE
- Mir Qasim tried to restore autonomy through administrative reform, military reorganisation and abolition of inland duties
- this threatened Company privilege.
- Buxar mattered more militarily because the Company defeated a combined Bengal-Awadh-Mughal force, proving supremacy beyond palace politics.
- Allahabad (1765) gave the Company Diwani while keeping Awadh as a buffer, producing a revenue-backed territorial corporation.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels